Learning content is a database contract.

What happens to a course when the schema and the semantics drift apart.

10 slides · swipe

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'It's just text' — until the learner scores 40% lower.

The content pipeline touched: question shape, options, answer key, explanation. One mismatch downstream — the exam tests the wrong skill and the learner pays for it.

Content is data with feelings.
It still needs a schema.

My Russian-track content audit.

6 203

items audited for topic fit

45%

mismatched the skill they claimed to test

2 777

archived — graduates get the right questions

The full method: topic-fit model + human spot-checks.

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The four layers every content DB needs.

01 Question — the item itself, validated on write

↓

02 Explanation — chain of thought that survives reading

↓

03 Topic + skill tags — what it actually tests

↓

04 Answer key — one defensible correct answer

Drop one layer and the gradebook becomes a slot machine.

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What 'topic drift' actually looked like.

01 Grammar drills tagged as vocabulary

02 Two defensible answers in one item

03 Explanation contradicting the key — quietly

04 Difficulty inflation — exam items labeled 'easy'

Every item individually passed. The batch was a lie.

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Two ways to ship learning content.

FAST

Generate and pray

LLM writes it
it 'looks right'
ships to the exam

CONTRACT

Schema + defense

fields validated
answers defended
humans gate the border

Learning content is where 'probably right' is unacceptable.

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The audit pipeline, end to end.

01 Topic-fit model scores every item against its skill tag

↓

02 Low-confidence items flagged for human review

↓

03 Failures archived with backup — reversible forever

↓

04 Weekly re-audit — drift is a process, not an event

Content quality is a process, not a launch.

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Audit your content like a database.

Pick your 100 most-served items. Check item ↔ explanation ↔ skill ↔ answer-key alignment. Count the mismatches. That number is your real product quality.

100 items.
One honest hour.

The content law.

If content can't defend itself item by item, the syllabus is fiction and the gradebook is a casino.

Treat every item as a transaction — atomic or absent.

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CONTENT · KEEP THIS · 10/10

Save this for your next content review.

Whether you run a course, docs, or an onboarding flow — the schema ships before the content. Save this order for the next audit.

Save for later review

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